

ACTION GROUP

WORKBOOK

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MODULE ONE

SPIRITUAL IDENTITY

MODULE ONE

SPIRITUAL IDENTITY

Let's start at the beginning. Knowing your identity in Christ is crucial to understanding your role as a spiritual leader in your organization. Who has God created you to be? Do you believe that He has specifically equipped you and placed you in your role for a reason? If not, what's keeping you from believing that? In this module, we'll explore what you see your identity as and how to align that with how God sees you.

READING

- In preparation for this module, read the following article on **SPIRITUAL IDENTITY**.

Spiritual Identity.

A popular topic in Sunday School and Christian conferences. It is not a topic often talked about in the marketplace though.

When we do talk about spirituality in the marketplace, we talk about God's provision, reaching the lost or living missional.

The topic of identity is often glossed over – not seen as relevant to what we do from eight-to-five, but rather pushed aside for one’s private devotional life.

The truth of the matter is spiritual identity has everything to do with everything.

Understanding who God created us to be touches every single part of our lives. Especially our work, and if we are leaders – it touches the people we lead.

A leader who is looking for their identity in what they do, the people they lead or the product they produce is a ticking time bomb. This path always leads to disillusionment and burnout.

“Anyone who knows who God made them to be will never try to be someone else.” – Bill Johnson

It is not always as simple as it sounds to accept this though. There are some obstacles that lay between us and this place of freedom.

RESTORING RIGHT RELATIONSHIP

As is the case with most things that get off-track in our relationship with God, the misalignment is on our end – not His.

We must first believe that God is who He says He is, before we can believe we are who He says we are.

If you think about it, the value we place on what is being said often lies in the value of the person saying it.

If a random individual approached me in the grocery store and paid me a compliment, it would be flattering but would not hold a lot of weight. If that individual was known in the community to be a crooked businessman, the compliment would mean even less.

However, if the mayor bestowed a compliment and they were known to be a person of high integrity, this comment would be received differently.

It is the same in our relationship with God. Each of us walk around with our own doubts about God's character. Not one of us is exempt from this. All of us encounter suffering in a broken world. It is hard to take a look at our lives some days and really trust the goodness of God.

However, the suffering around us does not void out God's goodness. He is still a good leader when things go sideways in our lives. The more we recognize this, the more value we will see in what He says about us.

There may be areas in your life where you're believing a lie about God's character and it is robbing you of receiving the identity He wants to give you.

So, the real question we're left with is not whether we are loved by God, but whether we can receive His love.

CULTURE'S IDENTITY vs KINGDOM IDENTITY

In God's Kingdom our identity is clear.

"Oh yes, you shaped me first inside, then out; you formed me in my mother's womb. I thank you, High God – you're breathtaking! Body and soul, I am marvelously made! I worship in adoration – what a creation! You know me inside and out, you know every bone in my body; You know exactly how I was made, bit by bit, how I was sculpted from nothing into something. Like an open book, you watched me grow from conception to birth; all the stages of my life were spread out before you, the days of my life all prepared before I'd even lived one day." – **Psalms 139:14-16**

"For we are His workmanship, created in Christ Jesus for good works, which God prepared beforehand, that we should walk in them." – **Ephesians 2:10**

"Why, even the hairs of your head are all numbered. Fear not; you are of more value than many sparrows." – **Luke 12:7**

This is no mistake – there was God-breathed identity on your life before you could even take a breath of your own. If this is true, there is nothing we can do that would add to this.

We can add to spiritual gifts, maturity, talents and skills, but our very identity as sons and daughters is not affected by what we do.

We live in a culture that fuses our identity to what we do. We are told that our identity lies in our gross profit, our amount of social media followers, and even our church attendance.

All of these things can be a result of healthy identity, but they do not create identity itself.

If we search for our identity in these places, we will come up dry every time.

ALIGN IDENTITY, REFINE LEADERSHIP

So why is all of this so important in the marketplace?

If we are walking around looking to receive our identity from the things we do or the people around us, not only does this hurt us, but in leadership, that hurt will ripple through the people we lead.

We believe all leadership is spiritual. Sometimes that is the Holy Spirit, and sadly, other times it is not. But all leadership is influenced by one spirit or another. Sometimes, it is a spirit of comparison, envy or greed.

If God has charged us to take care of His people, but we are counting on them to tell us who we are, we are not reflecting the Father's heart to them.

A Kingdom Leader has to be receiving their identity from God, and God alone.

This is not to say we'll always get it perfect. But when we mess up, we recognize it and realign ourselves with who God says we are, and we repent to those around us if our insecurities have hurt them.

You are not in leadership by mistake. God has anointed and appointed you to be leading the people you lead.

If you are boldly living from a place of belonging, hurting and lost people will be drawn

to the light you shine. This is how God's Kingdom is advanced in the marketplace. Not through trying to live more missional or creating more programs, but by living in the truth and freedom of who God created you to be. People want to be around free people.

We have an enemy who hates this and opposes the advancement of God's Kingdom, so when he strikes, he goes for the jugular – he goes for our very identity.

So, we must ask ourselves, “who am I allowing to define me?”

We must seek Jesus to understand who we are according to Him and intentionally reject the lies of the enemy because he is trying to steal, kill and destroy our identity.

When we live in the place of knowing we are fully seen, completely known, and perfectly loved, our lives become catalysts for advancing the Kingdom, and if we can live this out at work, the Kingdom is then advanced in the marketplace.

INTRODUCTIONS

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MY COMMITMENT TO ACTION

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SELF-REFLECTION

Take time to consider in what ways you are looking for identity and approval from those you lead. Write out one simple step you can take to change this.

How might you build a culture that does not encourage your employees to put all of their identity into what they do?

SUPPORTING CONTENT



REFLECTING ON SPIRITUAL IDENTITY

Holly Betenbough reflects on what healthy spiritual identity looks like – in our lives and in the marketplace.

DUNAGIN TRANSPORT

Watch the transformation of a man whose double life lead to disaster and ultimately reprioritizing everything.



MODULE TWO

SPIRITUAL CALLING

MODULE TWO

SPIRITUAL CALLING

The counterpart to spiritual identity is spiritual calling. Once you know who God has created you to be, you can better understand what He has created you to do. He has uniquely called you into your position of leadership and has uniquely equipped you to lead spiritually and raise your people up to their highest potential. In this module, we'll break down the meaning of work and how when done well, it is worship to God.

READING

In preparation for this module, read the following:

- THEOLOGY OF WORK ARTICLE, **PAGE 16 IN THE LEADERS GUIDE**

ACCOUNTABILITY - RESULTS FROM MY ACTION ITEMS

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SELF-REFLECTION

Based on what was shared in the video, as a business owner/leader what is your spiritual calling?

What does the word Avodah mean? Do you think the meaning of this word is achievable in your business?

SUPPORTING CONTENT



REFLECTING ON THE THEOLOGY OF WORK

Why do we place work in one box and ministry in another? Where did this idea come from? These questions are tackled in this video with Ron Betenbough.

BARNETT SIGNS

Watch this film about an owner who sees his work in the marketplace as a way to serve God and help people understand who God created them to be.



MODULE THREE

SPIRITUAL LEADERSHIP

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SPIRITUAL LEADERSHIP

All leadership is spiritual, the question is, by what spirit are you leading? Leaning into the Holy Spirit and following His leading can transform your life and your company. But you can't be led by God, unless you intentionally spend time with Him. In the module, we will explore seeking first His Kingdom, and how that shift will naturally change the way you lead.

READING

In preparation for this module, read the following:

- SPIRITUAL LEADERSHIP ARTICLE, **PAGE 26 IN THE LEADERS GUIDE**

ACCOUNTABILITY - RESULTS FROM MY ACTION ITEMS

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MY COMMITMENT TO ACTION

SELF-REFLECTION

Do you have a regular rhythm of spending time in God's word? If not, what needs to change?

What does spiritual leadership look like in your business currently?

SUPPORTING CONTENT

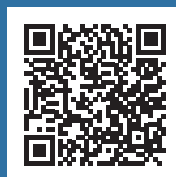


KINGDOM LEADER WITH RICK BETENBOUGH

A Kingdom leader is wholly submitted to God, called and appointed by God, and equipped and empowered by God. When God begins to transform any business or ministry, His first order of business could very well be to transform you.

REFLECTING ON SPIRITUAL LEADERSHIP

Learn more about what it could look like to integrate spiritual leadership in the marketplace.



MODULE FOUR

HEARING FROM GOD

MODULE FOUR

HEARING FROM GOD

God wants to speak to you. He wants to give you direction for leading His business. But if you aren't used to spending time listening to His voice, it can feel a bit intimidating. In this module, Holly Betenbough will break down how we can hear God's voice on basic, everyday decisions.

ACCOUNTABILITY - RESULTS FROM MY ACTION ITEMS

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MY COMMITMENT TO ACTION

SELF-REFLECTION

What obstacles get in your way of hearing from God and/or spending time with Him?

What has God been speaking to you lately?

SUPPORTING CONTENT



CLARITY VS. TRUST

Learn more about why you don't have to be the one to provide clarity, you simply have to know and trust the One who does.

ASK THE LORD TO LEAD YOU

Learn more about how to begin allowing the Lord to lead you in your leadership.



MODULE FIVE

PURPOSE: WHY vs. WHAT

MODULE FIVE

PURPOSE: WHY VS. WHAT

Understanding purpose is a very important part of this journey. What you do and why you do it are two different things. Your purpose reveals your priorities. Are you prioritizing profit, reputation, relationships, building God's Kingdom, or something else completely? In this module, we'll discuss the difference between why and what, and get one step closer to developing your purpose for your business.

READING

In preparation for this module, read the following:

- THE CENTER OF WHAT WE DO, **PAGE 69 IN THE LEADERS GUIDE**

ACCOUNTABILITY - RESULTS FROM MY ACTION ITEMS

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WATCH THIS VIDEO

Watch this module's video from Walter Cunningham on the difference between what you do and why you do it.

DISCUSSION

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MY COMMITMENT TO ACTION

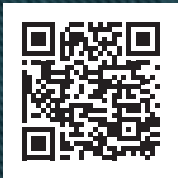
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SELF-REFLECTION

What do you think God's purpose is for your business?

As a leader, how do you stretch yourself professionally, personally, and spiritually?

SUPPORTING CONTENT

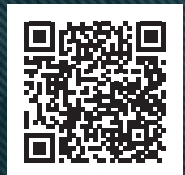


WHY VS. WHAT

Regardless of what it is we do each day as Kingdom leaders to provide value in the marketplace, our why is what has endless impact.

NARROW GATE

Watch this film to hear how Narrow Gate equips and trains young men in woodworking, leather-working and other life skills in the woods of Franklin, Tennessee.



MODULE SIX

DEVELOPING YOUR PURPOSE

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DEVELOPING YOUR PURPOSE

Developing your purpose is a very important step. Whether you are starting from scratch or refining your purpose, knowing what it is and communicating it are key to building a Kingdom enterprise. And then once you have it defined, your next step as a leader is to defend it. In this module, we'll walk through developing your purpose and sharing it with those you lead.

READING

In preparation for this module, read the following:

- **DECISION MAKING: DON'T GO SOLO, PAGE 172 IN THE LEADERS GUIDE**

ACCOUNTABILITY - RESULTS FROM MY ACTION ITEMS

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MY COMMITMENT TO ACTION

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SELF-REFLECTION

Do you currently have a purpose statement? If not, what steps should you take to define one? If you do, does it need to be redefined?

Do you have a testimony on receiving feedback from a trusted leader(s) in your organization that helped you form a better perspective on a certain situation? What was the outcome?

SUPPORTING CONTENT



REFLECTING ON DECISION MAKING

Hear from Cal Zant on how making decisions alongside others has personally changed his life and the way he leads.

MODULE SEVEN

HOUSE RULES & CULTURE

MODULE SEVEN

HOUSE RULES & CULTURE

Once you have a purpose, it's time to use that to develop your core values and culture. These will make your purpose better understood by people at all levels on the organizational chart, as well as give them guidelines for what it takes to be successful in your company. In this modules, we'll discuss house rules, culture, and how the best people for your company might not be only christians.

READING

In preparation for this module, read the following:

- CULTURAL FIT DOESN'T EQUAL CHRISTIAN, **PAGE 57 IN THE LEADERS GUIDE**
- WHAT DO YOU CELEBRATE?, **PAGE 227 IN THE LEADERS GUIDE**

ACCOUNTABILITY - RESULTS FROM MY ACTION ITEMS

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WATCH THIS VIDEO



Watch this module's video from the Kingdom Leadership Workshop to hear Jeanna Roach discuss the importance of culture in a business.

DISCUSSION

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MY COMMITMENT TO ACTION

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SELF-REFLECTION

Does your culture point back to the why (purpose) of your business?

How would you describe the current culture of your business?

SUPPORTING CONTENT



KINGDOM CULTURE FULL KEYNOTE

A Kingdom culture flows from the heart of the King through His appointed leader, displays the values of the King, and shapes the thoughts and values of its people. A Kingdom culture reveals the why behind the what.

MODULE EIGHT

WHAT IS A LEADERSHIP TEAM?

MODULE EIGHT

WHAT IS A LEADERSHIP TEAM?

It's important to not try to do this all on your own. More importantly, it's biblical to have a team, even if it's a team of two. Do you have a leadership team already? If not, do you have people already in your organization who are poised to take on a leadership role? In this module, we'll explore what a leadership team is and how to start building one.

READING

In preparation for this module, read the following:

- TEACH AND EMPOWER YOUR TEAM, **PAGE 197 IN THE LEADERS GUIDE**

ACCOUNTABILITY - RESULTS FROM MY ACTION ITEMS

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MY COMMITMENT TO ACTION

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SELF-REFLECTION

What do you believe the benefits of having a leadership team are?

Are you still running a zoo (monkey illustration) or have you developed a collaborative style of leadership where your team is solving problems without your input?

SUPPORTING CONTENT



LEADING LEADERS

Challenge yourself to shift your mindset to qualities that are core to leaders of leaders.

LEADING LEADERS (PART 2)

Learn more about how to steward the responsibility of leading leaders, and the core values to seek to find in leaders.



MODULE NINE

WHO SHOULD BE ON MY LEADERSHIP TEAM?

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WHO SHOULD BE ON MY LEADERSHIP TEAM?

How do you pick who should be on your leadership team? And if you have people in mind, how do you know if they're ready? As you think about building your team, the most important thing is to make sure you're asking God and being obedient to His leading. He will bring the right people into your organization or reveal the people to you that are already a part of the company. In this module, we will walk through who should be on your leadership team.

READING

In preparation for this module, read the following:

- NEW SKILLS AND FOCUS OF A LEADER, [PAGE 89 IN THE LEADERS GUIDE](#)
- HEALTHY TEAMS, [PAGE 208 IN THE LEADERS GUIDE](#)
- ORGANIZATIONAL LEADERSHIP IS A SPIRITUAL GIFT, [PAGE 54 IN THE LEADERS GUIDE](#)

ACCOUNTABILITY - RESULTS FROM MY ACTION ITEMS

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MY COMMITMENT TO ACTION

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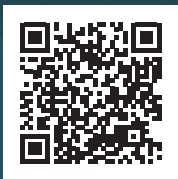
SELF-REFLECTION

Based on the leaders values mentioned, how do those play out on your leadership team?

Can you recognize those within your organization who have the gift of organizational leadership that needs to be developed further?

Do you see what you do as a leader, investing in others, as a cost or an investment?

SUPPORTING CONTENT



BUILDING HEALTHY TEAMS

As someone who leans towards being task oriented rather than people oriented, Paul Boecker, Director of Finance for Betenbough Companies, offers great thoughts on how to intentionally cultivate teams.

IMPACT OF MATURE LEADERSHIP

We live in a world that defines strong leadership in some pretty toxic ways. But what does leadership look like in God's Kingdom?



MODULE TEN

THE TEAM IS YOUR MISSION

MODULE TEN

THE TEAM IS YOUR MISSION

Most business owners are busy trying to keep the business afloat, putting out fires, strategizing for growth, and about a million other things. The purpose of building a team around you is to grant them real authority to handle all those things, so you have the capacity to truly lead them. In this module, we'll discuss how the team is your mission, and through relationship, you can empower them to lead their respective parts of the organization with authority and boldness.

READING

In preparation for this module, read the following:

- LET THEM MAKE THE WRONG DECISION, **PAGE 201 IN THE LEADERS GUIDE**

ACCOUNTABILITY - RESULTS FROM MY ACTION ITEMS

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MY COMMITMENT TO ACTION

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SELF-REFLECTION

Do you currently see that your leadership team is your mission? If not, do you agree with Rick that they should be?

Rick advised Cal that sometimes you have to let people make the wrong decision. What are your thoughts and experiences related to this statement?

SUPPORTING CONTENT



KNOW THEM AND GROW THEM

Learn more about the essence of committing to a relational style of leadership: knowing a person more over time so that you are able to partner with God in their growth.

MODULE ELEVEN

HOW DOES A LEADERSHIP TEAM WORK?

MODULE ELEVEN

HOW DOES A LEADERSHIP TEAM WORK?

Once you have a leadership team, it's important to understand the key dynamics that make the team work together. It comes down to relationship, humility, and diversity of thought. In this module, we'll break down how a leadership team works and how to be unified in your company's mission and purpose.

ACCOUNTABILITY - RESULTS FROM MY ACTION ITEMS

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ACTION MY COMMITMENT TO ACTION

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SELF-REFLECTION

Why is diversity on a leadership team so important?

What does unity look like on a leadership team?

SUPPORTING CONTENT



IS DISAGREEMENT ALWAYS A BAD THING?

Authentic unity never happens by accident. It requires an active style of leadership that welcomes a diversity of opinions, approaches, and ideas.

MODULE TWELVE

BUILD AN ALIGNED LEADERSHIP TEAM

MODULE TWELVE

BUILD AN ALIGNED LEADERSHIP TEAM

The most important aspect of an effective leadership team is alignment, specifically spiritual alignment. In order to lead a Kingdom business, you need leaders who are on board with this Kingdom perspective. They need to agree to be led by the Holy Spirit as you work as a team to make decisions for the wider company. In this module, we will discuss alignment, and how to attain it.

READING

In preparation for this module, read the following:

- OUR LEADERSHIP COVENANT, [PAGE 38 IN THE LEADERS GUIDE](#)

ACCOUNTABILITY - RESULTS FROM MY ACTION ITEMS

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WATCH THIS VIDEO

Watch this module's video from Rick Betenbough about the importance of alignment and unity in a leadership team.

DISCUSSION

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MY COMMITMENT TO ACTION

[illegible]

SELF-REFLECTION

If you have a person or several people on your leadership team, are they aligned and unified?

Is your leadership team aligned? If so, what have you set as standards to align to?

SUPPORTING CONTENT



EPPERSON PAYNE

Travis Epperson realized that he could welcome God's Kingdom into his business, bringing a new vision for unity and purpose to his team. Watch what happens as this dental group starts learning from the Lord and the principles His leadership is built on.

MODULE THIRTEEN

RELATIONAL STYLE

MODULE THIRTEEN

RELATIONAL STYLE

As a Kingdom leader, you are called to love the people you lead and build them up to their God-given potential. This is for their benefit, not the benefit of you or the company. But this relational style of leadership is not easy. In this module, we will break down how to know and grow your people.

READING

In preparation for this module, read the following:

- LONG VIEW LEADERSHIP, **PAGE 105 IN THE LEADERS GUIDE**
- 1-ON-1 101, **PAGE 108 IN THE LEADERS GUIDE**

ACCOUNTABILITY - RESULTS FROM MY ACTION ITEMS

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WATCH THIS VIDEO

Watch this module's video from Cal Zant about the importance of relational leadership.

DISCUSSION

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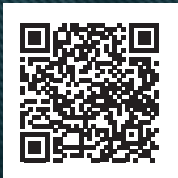
MY COMMITMENT TO ACTION

SELF-REFLECTION

What would it look like in your business to know and grow your employees?

Do you see the importance of 1-on-1's and if so, are you willing to make the effort to establish a healthy rhythm of 1-on-1 meetings within your organization?

SUPPORTING CONTENT

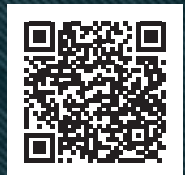


EEVOLVE

Love is at the center of this booming embroidery company in Muleshoe, TX. Watch how love was embodied even when co-founders made the decision to go their separate ways.

SIGMA PRO ENGINEERING

Watch this film to see what happens when an introverted engineer discovers a relational style of leadership and welcomes God into his workplace.



MODULE FOURTEEN

PRACTICAL RHYTHMS OF A RELATIONAL STYLE

MODULE FOURTEEN

PRACTICAL RHYTHMS OF A RELATIONAL STYLE

While we don't believe in recipes, there are a few practical tools that we use that help us lead our people relationally that you might find helpful. We recommend not copying and pasting these exactly into your organization but using the concepts to figure out what works for you. In this module, we'll walk through a few different ways to be engaged with your people and lead them through relationship.

ACCOUNTABILITY - RESULTS FROM MY ACTION ITEMS

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MY COMMITMENT TO ACTION

SELF-REFLECTION

If you're not closely engaged with your team, what's a next step you could take?

Read through John 4. Is there a takeaway you can implement in your relational style?

SUPPORTING CONTENT



RELATIONAL LEADERSHIP IN ACTION

One aspect of bringing the Kingdom of God into your workplace is committing to a relational style of leadership. Read this blog to learn more.

MODULE FIFTEEN

SELECT VS. HIRE

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SELECT VS. HIRE

Selecting the right team members is one of the most important things you can do as a leader. Finding the right people will help you not only grow in business but also defend your culture. In this module, we will discuss some practical aspects of hiring or selecting new team members and how to give them authority to do the job they were hired to do.

READING

In preparation for this module, read the following:

- SELECTION PROCESS, **PAGE 159 IN THE LEADERS GUIDE**
- THE URGENT VS. IMPORTANT, **PAGE 182 IN THE LEADERS GUIDE**

ACCOUNTABILITY - RESULTS FROM MY ACTION ITEMS

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WATCH THIS VIDEO

Watch this module's video from Lauren Hays on the importance of hiring well and perhaps a different view of the selection process.

DISCUSSION

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MY COMMITMENT TO ACTION

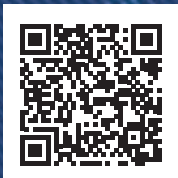
SELF-REFLECTION

What needs to change in your day-to-day so you can focus on finding the right person?

Referencing Jack Welch's quote, have you ever squinted on a candidate and later regretted it? What lessons did you learn?

How often do your days feel like you're fighting fires and not accomplishing work?

SUPPORTING CONTENT



WHEN HIRING SEEMS GRIM

Despite challenges in recruitment and hiring practices, here is some hope and encouragement as you search for your next team member.

MODULE SIXTEEN

COACHING AND CORRECTION

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COACHING AND CORRECTION

Loving your people does not give you an excuse to neglect accountability. In fact, it's that much more important. If we want to grow our employees, that means coaching and when necessary, correction. Ultimately, it's for the good of the employee, but learning how to lovingly hold someone accountable isn't always easy. In this module, we'll dive into the coaching continuum and how to speak in truth and love as we grow our people to reach their God-given potential.

READING

In preparation for this module, read the following:

- THE COACHING CONTINUUM, [PAGE 119 IN THE LEADERS GUIDE](#)
- COMFORT VS. COURAGE, [PAGE 133 IN THE LEADERS GUIDE](#)
- SPEAK IN TRUTH AND LOVE, [PAGE 135 IN THE LEADERS GUIDE](#)
- BEHAVIORS VS. MEASURABLES, [PAGE 138 IN THE LEADERS GUIDE](#)

ACCOUNTABILITY - RESULTS FROM MY ACTION ITEMS

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MY COMMITMENT TO ACTION

SELF-REFLECTION

Currently, what does coaching look like in your organization?

Would a version of the coaching continuum be helpful to your company? If yes, how could you start to implement a coaching continuum?

Can you recall a time when you chose comfort over courage in a situation? What were the ramifications of that decision?

SUPPORTING CONTENT



A DISCUSSION ON COACHING

Take a deep dive into this conversation on the topic of coaching and correction.

REFLECTING ON SPEAKING IN TRUTH & LOVE

Delivering feedback is arguably one of the more uncomfortable parts of leadership. Giving healthy, constructive feedback is even harder.





KINGDOM
at **WORK**

